Dylan Austin

Senior Content Designer & Content Strategist | Information Architecture, UX Writing & Cognitive Accessibility
Seattle, WA | hi@heydylan.xyz | heydylan.xyz | linkedin.com/in/heydylan

Summary

Content designer, UX writer, and strategist with 10 years of experience making complex digital systems clear, accessible, and navigable. Strongest where a service or product has to balance dense policy, compliance rules, or intricate system logic with everyday usability, reducing cognitive load and designing workflows that adapt to people rather than the other way around. Currently enrolled in Psychology and Accessibility & Disability Studies to complement my content design and UX strategy background, keeping digital experiences grounded in human behavior in an increasingly AI-driven world.

Education

Central Washington University
B.A. in Psychology, minor in Accessibility & Disability Studies (Anticipated Spring 2027)

Certifications

- Google UX Design Professional Certificate
- W3Schools Certified Accessibility Practitioner

Experience

Content Designer | Know Your Pet DNA by Ancestry | *March 2025—January 2026*

- Designed a near-ship role-based access framework for sharing pet DNA results, organizing collaborators by pet and defining invitation, pending, accepted, role-change, and revocation states.
- Led an account-settings redesign using competitive research and recurring Member Services support triggers to reorganize pet management, clarify inherited Ancestry account fields, and add intentional friction around deletion.
- Unified the distinct Know Your Pet DNA brand voice across product surfaces, managing legal and compliance reviews for sensitive health data and international sales copy across the US, the UK, Ireland, Australia, and New Zealand.
- Replaced ambiguous controls with descriptive labels and inline help, running continuous usability and accessibility testing for color contrast, tooltips, and screen-reader compatibility.

- Partnered with product and engineering on a Hygraph CMS migration and taxonomy cleanup, utilizing scalable content modeling to protect product and editorial content continuity after the product's success led to its acquisition by a new parent company.

Content Strategy Manager | Independence Pet Group | *June 2023—April 2025*

- Managed content strategy within a multi-brand pet insurance ecosystem, tailoring distinct brand voices and embedding accessible content standards into high-intent discovery and conversion work.
- Partnered with cross-functional design, development, and legal teams to execute UX/UI improvements and navigate strict compliance reviews for highly regulated insurance policies in an Agile shared-services model.
- Captured 80% of total organic traffic and secured a 92% YoY improvement in conversion rates for ASPCA Pet Health Insurance (APHI) by managing an optimized, structured content ecosystem.
- Drove a 4x growth in organic sales for APHI within 6 months by collaborating on UX/UI site optimizations that converted high-intent traffic into platform revenue.

Independent Content Strategy, Writing & Web Projects | January 2016—*January 2025*
Selected engagements; intermittent alongside employed roles.

- Wrote articles, interface copy, and search-focused content centering neurodiversity and LGBTQ+ communities, published by Apartment Therapy, Inflow, Figo Pet Insurance, UX Collective, and others.
- Advised a healthcare client on B2B compliance communications, providing structured feedback, core messaging frameworks, and comprehensive strategy documents.
- Managed e-commerce and operations strategy for a DTC brand, shaping its Shopify web presence, Klaviyo email flows for orders, subscriptions, and marketing, product description pages, and order fulfillment workflows.

Digital Copywriter | Ollie | *February 2023—June 2023*

- Wrote interface copy, lifecycle email, paid-search creative, and homepage and landing-page content across product and acquisition surfaces, ensuring strict adherence to compliance guidelines for nutritional claims.
- Supported conversion-focused copy iterations and A/B testing.

Editorial Content Writer | Pinterest | *June 2022—February 2023*

- Wrote approximately 1,500 pieces for Today's Inspiration and Shopping Spotlight across in-app and web discovery, championing campaigns focused on racial equity, disability, neurodiversity, and inclusivity.
- Wrote retention ads that ran across Meta platforms and trend-deck copy for Pinterest's U.S. Creator Management team, anchoring the brand voice in curiosity, creativity, and learning.

Communications Strategist | Drag Out The Vote | *March 2020—December 2020*

- Worked alongside the founder and a small team to scale an in-person voter-registration initiative into a national digital campaign, coordinating communications that supported 303 Drag Ambassadors across 44 states.
- Delivered accessible digital outreach (incorporating alt-text, video captions, and transcripts), virtual programming, and partner communications for a campaign that reported 500,000+ direct voter contacts and 1.25B+ media impressions.

Community

Board of Directors | Seattle Pride | 2020–2021 Pride Seasons
Contributed to organizational governance and accessibility initiatives, approving grant funding for community activation and supporting nonpartisan voter outreach programming.

Skills

Content design | UX writing | Content strategy | Information architecture | Agile methodology | Cross-functional collaboration | Content governance | Content modeling & taxonomy | Stakeholder management | Usability testing | Accessibility testing | Legal and compliance reviews | Role-based permissions | Error-state design | Edge-case modeling | Support-informed design | Wireframing and prototyping | Inclusive design | Neuro-inclusive design | Service design | Content audits | Brand voice

Tools & Languages

- **Design & Prototyping:** Figma, FigJam
- **Accessibility:** Apple VoiceOver, NVDA, WAVE, Lighthouse, WCAG contrast tools, accessibility linters, vision simulators, readability & plain language auditing
- **Web & Content Systems:** Headless & Enterprise CMS (Hygraph, Contentful, AEM, Drupal, Umbraco), WordPress, HTML/CSS
- **Agile & Collaboration:** Miro, Airtable, Notion, Jira
- **Logic & Workflows:** Conversational design mapping, context engineering, LLM workflow integration, AI-assisted wireframing & prototyping, edge-case validation
- **Languages (actively learning):** Spanish, American Sign Language